

LOW SPIRITS Arvind Kejriwal arrives in court following the ED summons, Mar. 16

ANI

THE BIG STORY

AAM AADMI PARTY

KEJRIWAL AT A CROSSROADS

The AAP chief has been central to the party's fortunes. His arrest in the Delhi liquor scam row could put their Lok Sabha poll campaign in disarray, and even trigger an existential crisis within

By **KAUSHIK DEKA**

It was during the India Against Corruption (IAC) agitation in 2011 that Arvind Kejriwal shot to national fame. The movement, allegedly backed by the RSS-BJP, gave voice to the public anger against graft at a time when the Congress-led United Progressive Alliance (UPA) government at the Centre was fighting allegations of several scams. Social activist Anna Hazare had been the face of the campaign but, by the next year, Kejriwal had shaped the public antipathy towards the political class into a creation of his making—the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP). Its election symbol, the broom, was an apt representation of its intent to clean up Indian polity, resonating widely with the capital's disillusioned electorate.

If the IAC was one of the factors behind the fall of the Congress across the nation, AAP wiped out the party in Delhi with a call to send the then chief minister Sheila Dikshit to jail for alleged involvement in corruption. But a decade into the